

Sailor Bow

Looped bow + pointed tails
Hair-clip finish
Seam allowance 1/4"

CUT LIST – 1/4" SEAM ALLOWANCE INCLUDED

Piece	Cut	Size	Page
A • Loop	1 on fold	12" × 6"	4
B • Tails	1 on fold	11" × 7", pointed ends	5
C • Center wrap	1	4" × 1 1/2"	6
D • Clip cover	1 (optional)	3" × 1"	6

YOU'LL NEED

- 1 fat quarter (18" × 22") quilting cotton – enough for one bow
- Matching thread + hand-sewing needle
- One 2" alligator clip
- Iron, rotary cutter or shears, chalk or fabric pen
- Optional: lightweight fusible interfacing for piece A, fabric glue for the clip



The finished bow – loops up, mitered tails hanging apart.

FINISHED SIZE

6" wide • 8 1/2" long

BEFORE YOU CUT

Print pages 4-6 at **100% / Actual size** – no "fit to page". Measure the 1" check square on each pattern page before cutting.

Fabric

Grainlines run along the length of A and B. The tails hang at an angle, so an all-over or tossed print looks best.

Pressing

Press after every seam. Cotton takes a hard press – crisp loops depend on it.

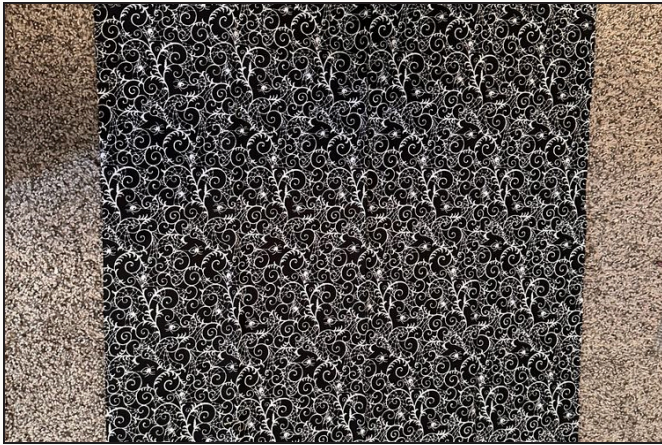
Skill

Confident beginner. Straight seams, two mitered points, a little hand-tacking.

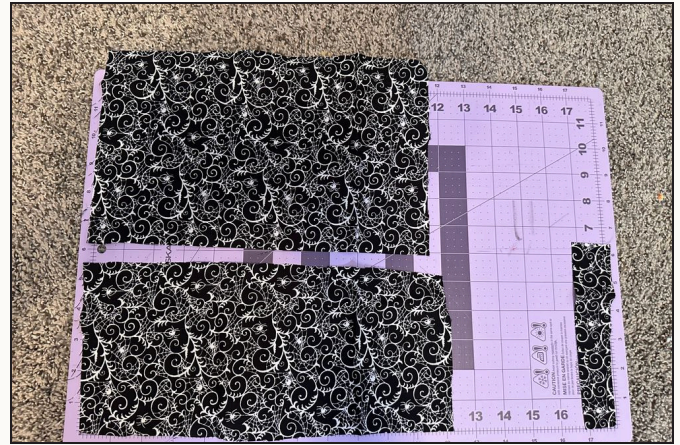
- 01 **Cut.** Fold your fabric and lay pieces A and B on the fold as marked. Cut one of each. Cut C and D from a single layer. Press everything flat.
- 02 **Loop tube.** Fold A in half lengthwise, right sides together, to 12" × 3". Sew the long raw edge with a 1/4" seam, leaving both short ends open. Turn right side out through one end.
- 03 **Press the seam to the back.** Roll the tube so the seam sits centered on one face – that face becomes the back of the bow. Press hard. Finished tube: 12" × 2 3/4".
- 04 **Form the loops.** Bring both short ends of the tube to the middle so they overlap 1/2" at the center back, and stitch across the overlap – by hand, or with a machine zigzag. You now have a double loop about 5 3/4" wide. Pinch its center into two or three folds and wind thread tightly round a few times to hold.
- 05 **Tails.** Fold B in half lengthwise, right sides together, to 11" × 3 1/2" – the fold is the long edge with the points at its ends. Sew the long raw edge and both diagonal ends with a 1/4" seam, leaving the 2" gap marked at the center. Trim the points close to the stitching, turn right side out through the gap, poke the points sharp, press, and slip-stitch the gap closed – it ends up under the wrap.
- 06 **Gather the tails.** At the middle of B, fold 3-4 accordion pleats across its width until the center measures about 1 1/2" from top to bottom. Wind thread tightly round the pleats to hold them.
- 07 **Center wrap.** Press C's long edges to the middle, then fold in half again lengthwise and press – a finished strip about 3/8" wide. Topstitch the open edge if you like.
- 08 **Join.** Center the loop unit on top of the pleated tails, backs together. Wrap C snugly once around both, over the pinched centers, and hand-stitch its ends down at the back. Keep the wrap tight – it's what holds the bow's shape.
- 09 **Clip.** Fold D the same way as C, wrap it around the top blade of the alligator clip and glue. Once dry, glue or stitch the clip to the back of the center wrap, opening downward.
- 10 **Shape.** Steam the loops and pull them open into rounded ears, then press the tails so the points hang straight and slightly apart.

Fitting notes. For a stiffer bow, fuse lightweight interfacing to the wrong side of A before step 2. For longer tails, cut B longer than 11" but keep the 1 1/2" diagonal, so the points keep their pitch.

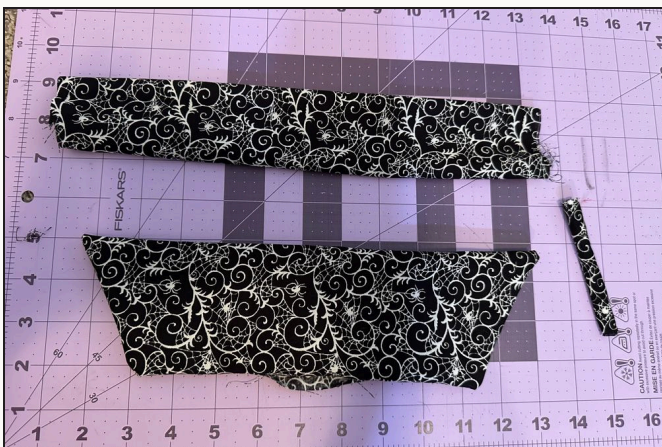
Reference



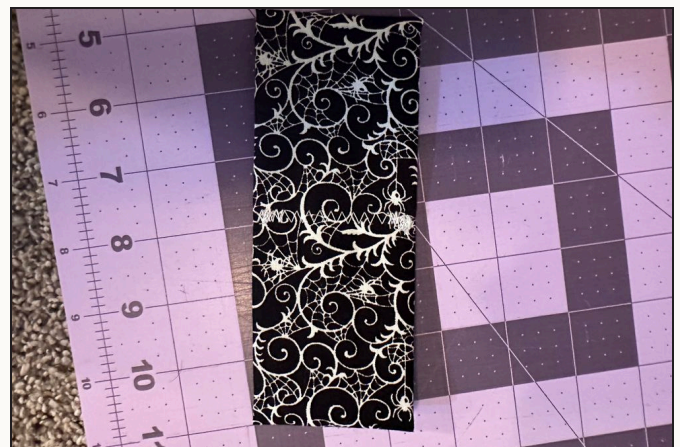
Fabric. Quilting cotton – a fat quarter is enough for one bow.



Step 1. Pieces cut on the fold and squared up on the mat.



Steps 2 & 5. Loop tube, tail unit with its mitered edge, and the wrap strip.



Step 4. Ends brought to the middle, overlapped and zigzagged across.



Steps 4 & 6. Tails and loop each pinched and tied, wrap strip ready beside them.

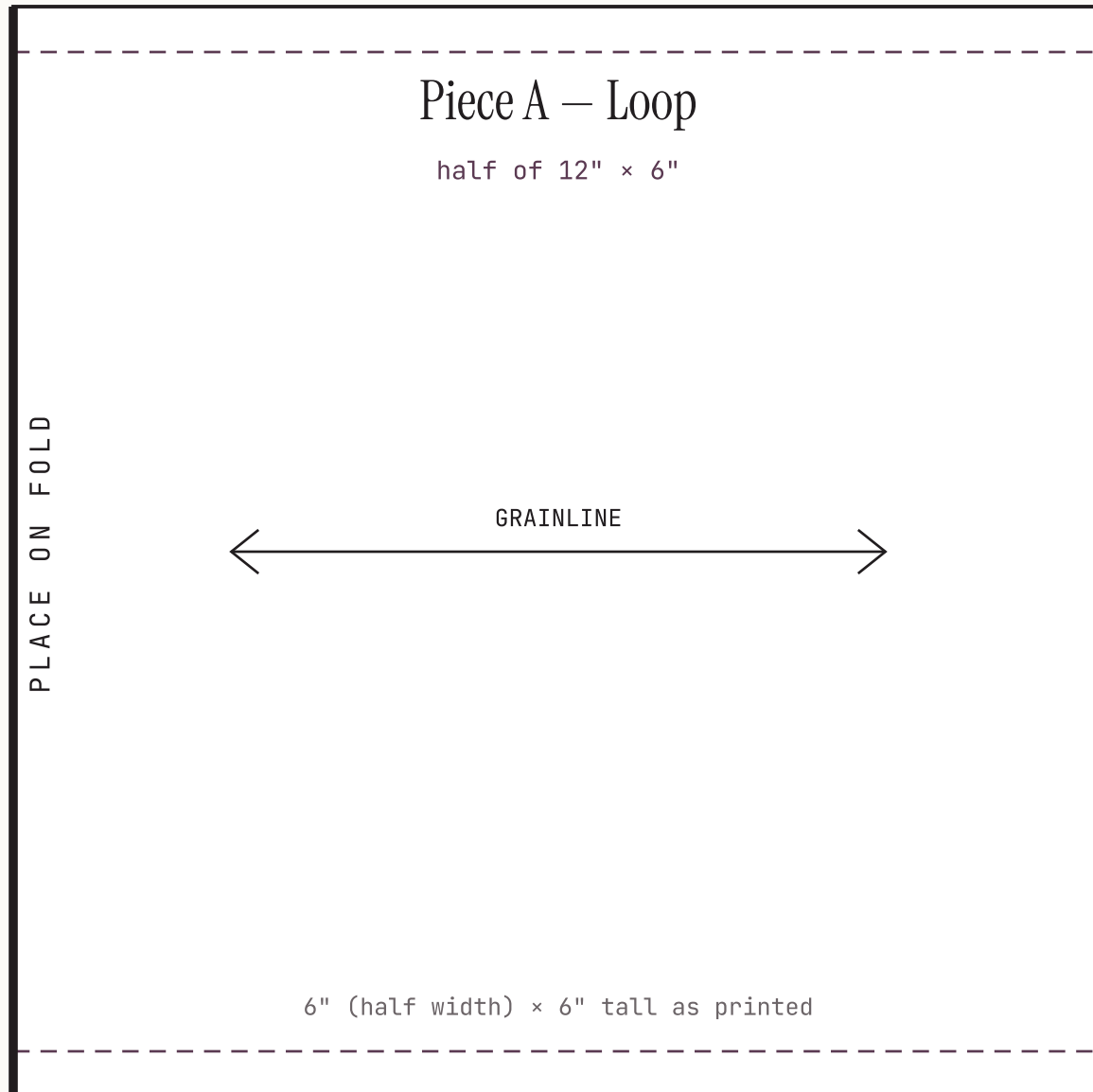
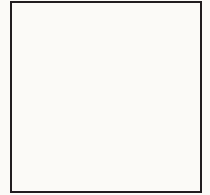


Step 10. Steamed and opened out: loops rounded, points hanging straight.

A·Loop

Cut 1 on fold · full size · 1/4" SA included

1" check

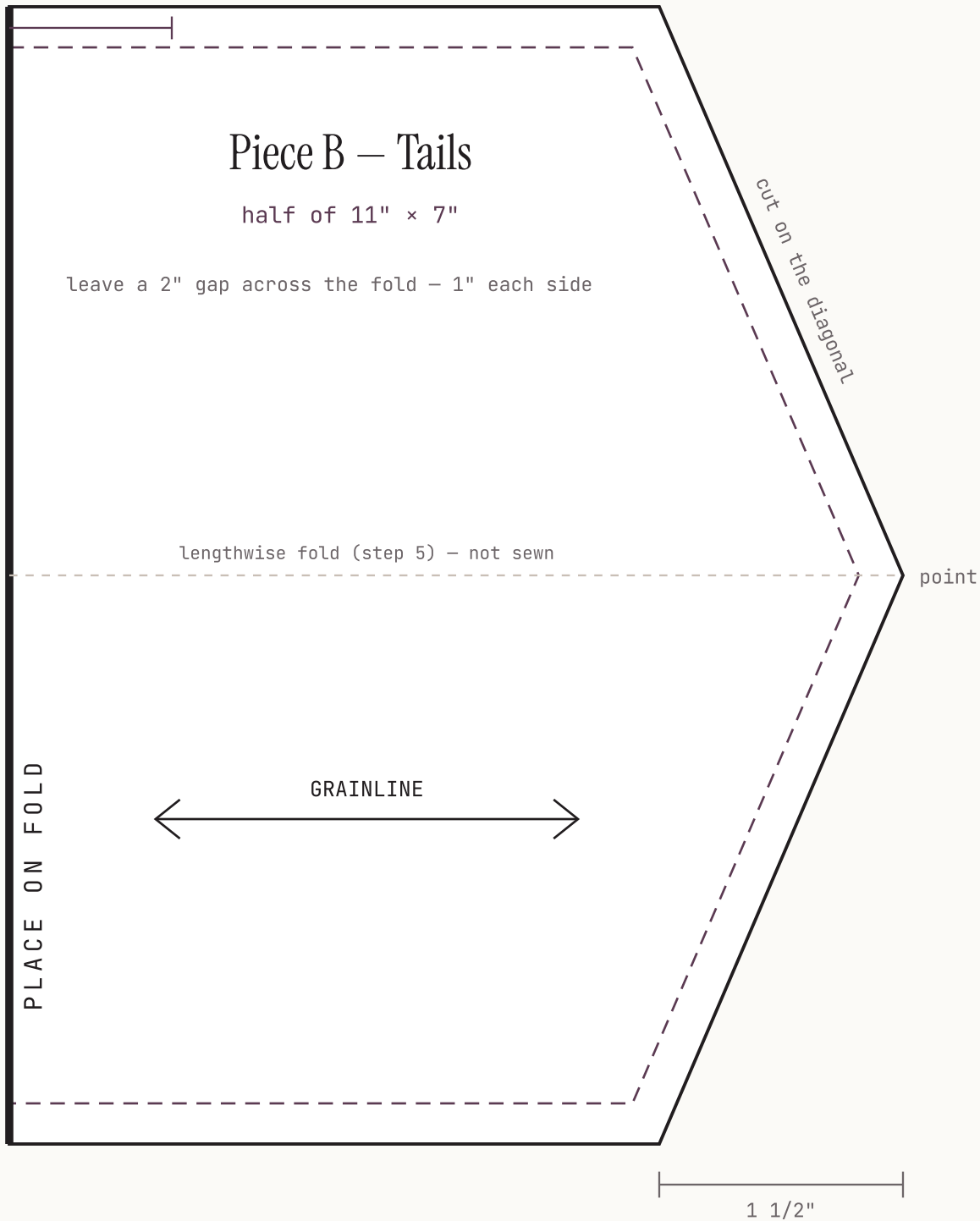
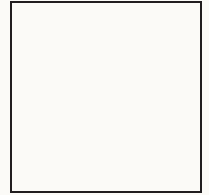


Solid line = cut. Dashed line = 1/4" stitching line. Heavy line = fold – no seam allowance on that edge.

B·Tails

Cut 1 on fold • full size • 1/4" SA included

1" check

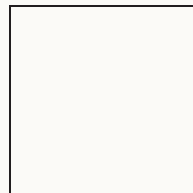


Opened out, B is one 11" x 7" piece with a shallow point at each end. No printer? Cut an 11" x 7" rectangle, fold it in half lengthwise, and at each end cut from the corner on the fold to a mark 1 1/2" in along the raw edges.

C & D · Wraps

Single layer · full size

1" check



Piece C — Center wrap

cut 1 · 4" × 1 1/2"

Piece D — Clip cover

cut 1 · 3" × 1" · optional

Folding C and D

The faint lines mark the quarter folds. Press both long edges in to the center line, then fold along the center and press again — C finishes about 3/8" wide, D about 1/4".

One wrap, not two

Cotton bulks up at the center, and C is cut for one snug wrap plus a hand-stitch — which is plenty. For a double wrap, cut C about 8" long instead.